

SDG Goal 8 Decent work and economic growth

SDG Target 8.3 Promote development-oriented policies that support productive activities, decent job creation, entrepreneurship, creativity and innovation, and encourage the formalization and growth of micro-, small- and medium-sized enterprises, including through access to financial services

SDG Indicator 8.3.1 Proportion of informal employment in total employment, by sector and sex

Time series Proceedings initiated in connection with undeclared work and illegal employment

1. General information on the time series

- Date of national metadata: May 29, 2026
- National data: <https://sdg-indicators.de/8-3-1>
- Definition: The time series shows the number of proceedings initiated by the Financial Control Authority for Illegal Employment (FKS) in connection with undeclared work and illegal employment.
- Disaggregation: Type of proceeding, Sector, Land

2. Comparability with the UN metadata

- Date of UN metadata: March 2026
- UN metadata: <https://unstats.un.org/sdgs/metadata/files/Metadata-08-03-01.pdf>
- The time series is not compliant with UN metadata, but provides additional information. It shows the number of proceedings initiated in connection with undeclared work and illegal employment, but not the actual extent of informal employment.

3. Data description

- The data are taken from the labour statistics of the Financial Control Unit for Undeclared Work (FKS). The FKS is a specialized unit within the General Customs Directorate that investigates offences relating to undeclared work and illegal employment.

The number of proceedings initiated do not distinguish between cases preceded by an employer inspection and those initiated, for example, on the basis of specific tips or other findings. It is therefore not possible to compare the number of proceedings initiated with the number of employer inspections. Consequently, the number of proceedings initiated does not provide a direct indication of the extent of undeclared work actually taking place.

In the FKS's labour statistics, only the principal offence is reported for each proceeding. An administrative offence is only recorded as the principal offence in the statistics if no criminal offence is also involved. Even if several offences are committed, therefore, only the principal offence is included in the statistical analysis.

In total, the FKS distinguishes between 29 sectors. The sectors presented here – “construction”, “catering and hotel”, “hairdressing and beauty”, and “haulage, transport and associated logistics” – are those in which the highest number of administrative offence and criminal proceedings are regularly initiated.

4. Access to data source

- Labour statistics of the Financial Control Authority for Illegal Employment (only available in German):
https://www.zoll.de/DE/Fachthemen/Arbeit/Bekaempfung-der-Schwarzarbeit-und-illegalen-Beschaeftigung/Statistikveroeffentlichung/statistikveroeffentlichung_node.html

5. Metadata on source data

- Not available.

6. Timeliness and frequency

- Timeliness: t + 2 months
- Frequency: Annual

7. Calculation method

- Unit of measurement: Number
- Calculation: Not applicable.